



GET LUCKY GOLF · DEEP RESEARCH

HOLE-IN-ONE SIMULATOR SOFTWARE

Everything we need to know to build it: the market, the tech, shot integrity, the law, insurance, the money and the build plan for a global hole-in-one game that runs on any golf simulator.

FEASIBLE. BUILD IT IN STAGES.

PREPARED FOR

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REPO

getluckyjo/simsoftware

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The idea. Get Lucky Sim is software that runs on any golf simulator. It hosts a rotating collection of the world's most exciting par-3s. Anyone can play them free. Players can also back themselves with a paid, insured shot, and a hole-in-one wins up to **\$100,000**. This takes the on-course Get Lucky model, already live in South Africa and insured by Santam through Indwe, to the fastest-growing part of golf.

Verdict. Feasible and worth building, but only in stages and only with discipline on one thing: **shot integrity**. The market is large and growing, and **9M+ Americans** already play on simulators. Paid shots on simulators are proven: Full Swing's Skill Strike paid out \$400K in its first month. Insurance for simulator holes-in-one exists. But nobody owns "**one swing at a famous hole for life-changing money, on any simulator**". Three facts shape how it has to be built:

- 1. Simulator data can be faked.** The industry-standard GSPro Open Connect feed is unauthenticated JSON on a local port. A 20-line script can send a perfect ace. Paid shots therefore need our own server-side physics, fixed cameras, a witness and partner data feeds. They start at **certified venue bays**, not home sims.
- 2. Simulator aces happen more often than real ones.** Golfzon's own data works out to about **1 in 7,000** par-3 shots, against about 1 in 12,500 for an amateur on a real course. Korea's per-game screen-golf insurance ran claims **16x higher** than on-course cover and loses money. Prizes must scale with distance, and paid attempts must be capped.
- 3. Money on a single shot is a legal grey zone.** US precedent (Florida AGO 90-58; *Las Vegas Hacienda v. Gibson*) treats an insured hole-in-one contest as a prize contract, not a bet. But single-shot odds mean some markets will treat it as gambling. Free play goes global. Paid shots open market by market, starting with **South Africa and the US "dominant-factor" states**.

The recommendation.

- Build a lightweight **Unity "adjudicator" app** plus a cloud platform. Don't build a full simulator.
- Launch free worldwide.
- Switch on paid insured shots at partner venues in South Africa and then the US.
- Pursue TrackMan as the premium data partner.
- The build is estimated at **\$0.9M-1.3M over 12 months** with a nine-person, South Africa-led team. It reuses the claims, evidence and risk engine Get Lucky already runs in production.

9M+

US simulator players in 2025; half are not on-course golfers

1 IN 7,000

Golfzon par-3 ace rate (2022), easier than the real world

~45%

Blended margin per paid shot after premium, venue share and fees (base case)

\$0.9-1.3M

12-month MVP build, SA-led team

2,500 BAYS

Year-3 base case: about \$16M revenue

NEXT

Three things unlock everything else: an insurer term sheet for simulator aces, a South African legal opinion, and one launch-monitor partner (TrackMan or Uneekor) willing to send signed shot data. All three can run in parallel during the first 90 days.

THE MARKET

How big it is

Analysts put the global golf-simulator market at **\$2.0-2.9B in 2025**. Most estimates cluster at \$2.0-2.2B, growing **7.4-9.8% a year** to \$2.9-4.7B by 2030-34:

- Grand View: \$2.1B
- Mordor: \$1.97B
- Global Market Insights: \$2.1B
- Straits: \$2.08B
- M2 Square: \$2.9B

Commercial venues account for about half, and home simulators are the fastest-growing segment at about 11.6% a year.

READ THIS CAREFULLY

These reports count **hardware and installation**, not what people spend on play. Korean screen golf alone is described as a ~\$1.6B market. Treat "\$2B" as the equipment market. The money we compete for is play spend: bay fees of about \$55 a session in the US, plus about \$40 on food and drink.

Who plays

United States

- **9M+ Americans** played on a simulator in 2025, up from 3.8M in 2015 (NGF).
- **51% of them are not on-course golfers**. For Get Lucky that is the key point: half the audience is new to golf and plays for fun and competition.
- About **1,500 commercial simulator businesses** run 3-4 bays each, roughly 4,500-6,000 bays. That is before hotels, bars and gyms.
- 6.5% of US golf facilities have simulators today, and NGF expects 10-11% within two years.

Korea

- 8,700-9,700 screen-golf venues. Golfzon logged about 94M rounds in 2024, **nearly twice the country's outdoor rounds**.

Golfzon worldwide

- About 13,000 locations in 40+ countries, 6M+ members and 100M+ rounds in 2025.

Rest of the world (R&A, excluding the US and Mexico)

- 112M golfers, and **68M play off-course**, including ranges and simulators.

UK and South Africa

- UK simulator market about \$118-194M, heading for about £235M by 2030.
- South Africa about \$11M, doubling by 2033. It is small but it is our home market, and the simulator-channel plan targets 200+ gym bays.

9M+

US simulator players, 2025

51%

of US sim players are not on-course golfers

~13,000

Golfzon locations in 40+ countries

100M+

Golfzon rounds played in 2025

68M

off-course golfers outside the US (R&A)

Hardware: fragmented, and that shapes the product

Around ten launch-monitor makers split the market, from the \$600 Garmin R10 to \$25K TrackMan and \$90K Golfzon TwoVision bays.

MAKER	TYPICAL PRICE	OUR ACCESS
TrackMan 4 / iO	\$14-30K + ~\$1,100/yr software	Closed, partner only
Golfzon TwoVision / Vision	\$21K (home) - \$90K (commercial)	Closed, partner only
Full Swing Pro / KIT	\$45-70K / \$4,999	Partner (owns Skill Strike)
Foresight GCQuad / GC3 / Falcon; Bushnell LP	\$2.5-18.5K	Partner programme
Uneekor EYE XO2 / Mini	\$4.5-11K	Launcher allow-list
FlightScope Mevo+, Square Golf, ProTee	\$0.7-2.2K	Open Connect, day one
Garmin R10 / R50, Rapsodo MLM2PRO, SkyTrak+	\$0.6-5K	Community bridges or partner

No credible count of home simulators exists anywhere. We'll build our own count from free-play installs.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Paid shots on simulators already exist, so the concept is proven

OFFER	MODEL	PRIZE	VERIFICATION
Full Swing Skill Strike (Nov 2025)	\$3-20 per swing, target size set by an AI handicap; 44 US states; 200+ venues	Up to 8x stake; \$750 for an ace on a \$3 swing. \$400K paid out and 20 aces in month one	One player logged in, every swing stored, AI flags sudden changes in performance
PinSeeker	Cash closest-to-pin on Full Swing, E6, FSX	Claims \$24K paid weekly	Not disclosed
Five Iron Tournaments (May 2026)	Real-money tournament network, ~50 TrackMan venues	\$20K guaranteed closest-to-pin pool	In-venue TrackMan
TrackMan NEXT Golf Tour	\$130 qualifiers, online	\$100K+ purses; closest-to-pin \$1,250	Phone video + TrackMan data + rules committee
Golfzon G-Membership ace pool (Korea)	Paid membership	₩30M shared between aces	Pro difficulty, no mulligans, NASMO swing video
Korean per-game ace insurance	₩1,000-2,410 a game	₩200-300K	Checked against the simulator record
Venue specials (Condor, 100 Kellogg Lane)	\$10-20 for 8-10 shots	\$5-10K	Staff witness, data and video review

Where the gap is

Nobody offers an **insured, big-prize hole-in-one** (\$10K-\$100K) that runs **across hardware brands**, sits under a **consumer brand** and has a **catalogue of famous holes**. The field divides into three camps:

- **Hardware makers** lock their games to their own devices. Skill Strike is Full Swing only.
- **Venue chains** run their own events.
- **Korean products** pay small prizes.

Skill Strike proves venues and players will pay per swing, and that 44 US states can host a skill game. It also shows the risk: **20 aces in under a month**.

POSITIONING

Skill Strike is a skill *wager* that pays small multiples. Get Lucky Sim is the **big moment**: one swing at a famous hole for life-changing money, insured and verified like the on-course product. It is on any hardware we can trust and free to play everywhere.

Distribution partners

CHAIN	SIZE	HARDWARE
Topgolf Swing Suite	220 locations	Full Swing
X-Golf	138 locations, 38 states	Own
Back Nine	100+	Full Swing (already runs Skill Strike)
Five Iron Golf	~50 locations, 500+ bays, 7 countries	TrackMan
Golfzon (US)	~160 sites, growing 90%+ a year	Golfzon
Gyms (Virgin Active, Planet Fitness SA)	272 bays planned in Get Lucky's simulator strategy	Golfzon (proposed)

THE PRODUCT

What the player sees

1. **Open Get Lucky Sim** on the simulator PC, or scan the QR code on the bay screen at a partner venue.
2. **Pick a hole** from the Collection: signature par-3s from around the world, each with a story, a real yardage and a prize ladder.
3. **Play free**. Unlimited shots, closest-to-the-pin leaderboards, daily challenges and badges. No account is needed for a first swing.
4. **Back yourself**. Choose a paid tier. The tee locks at that tier's distance. The cameras arm, a shot code appears on screen, and the player gets one swing.
5. **Result**. A miss shows proximity and the leaderboard. An ace fires the celebration, freezes the evidence and starts the claim. The winner is verified and paid out within the published window, as with the on-course product.

The Collection

The launch set has 8–12 par-3s, each "inspired by" a famous hole until it has been licensed (see *Course content & licensing*). The candidates cover the holes golfers already dream about:

- an island green in the style of Sawgrass 17;
- a Postage Stamp-style wedge;
- a cliff-top ocean carry in the style of Pebble Beach 7;
- a Fancourt Links hole;
- a Glendower 14th. The simulator strategy's pitch assets already include one.

Seasonal holes and sponsor-named holes rotate through the Collection.

Prize ladder (recommended)

The prize grows with the multiple and the distance. The longer tee protects the economics, and the gated top tier keeps the "up to \$100K" headline honest. The multiples mirror the South African on-course ladder, which runs from 500× (R50 for R25,000) to 1,000× (R1,000 for R1,000,000).

TIER	ENTRY	PRIZE	MULTIPLE	TEE DISTANCE	GATE
Starter	\$5	\$2,500	500×	150–165 yds	Age and location check
Classic	\$10	\$5,000	500×	160–175 yds	Age and location check
Pro	\$25	\$15,000	600×	170–185 yds	Account verified
Major	\$50	\$35,000	700×	180–195 yds	Full KYC, certified venue
Legend	\$100	\$100,000	1,000×	195–210 yds	Full KYC, handicap on file, 3 attempts a day, live witness

Local-currency ladders follow the same multiples. A ZAR ladder for South African venues can reuse today's app tiers directly.

Free-to-play is the engine, not a side dish

Free play serves three purposes:

- It is top-of-funnel for paid shots.
- It gives sponsors inventory: named holes, branded tee boxes, prizes.
- Most importantly, it is **the actuarial dataset**. Every free shot on our own physics tells the insurer, and us, what the real ace rate is for each hole, distance and handicap. That is how premiums come down over time.

 SIMULATOR INTEGRATION

How shot data flows today

Almost every modern simulator setup speaks one de facto standard: **GSPro Open Connect v1**.

- The launch monitor's software opens a TCP socket to `127.0.0.1:921` and sends JSON.
- **BallData** carries speed, spin axis, total spin, and horizontal and vertical launch angles.
- **ClubData** is optional.
- The spec states plainly that the socket "does not require authentication" ([GSPro](#)).

- Open-source bridges translate most monitors into this format.

That makes free play easy to support broadly. For paid play, it is untrusted by design.

Launch-monitor support matrix

LAUNCH MONITOR	ROUTE TO OUR APP	FREE PLAY	PAID PLAY
FlightScope Mevo+ / Gen2	Official Open Connect output	✓ Day one	Home tier with video
Square Golf	Official Open Connect connector	✓ Day one	Home tier with video
ProTee VX / Full Swing KIT	Official partner integrations	✓ Day one	Partner deal
Garmin R10	Community bridge (emulates E6)	✓ Community	✗ Not trusted
Rapsodo MLM2PRO	Official via GSPro; community Bluetooth	✓ Community	✗ Until partnered
SkyTrak / SkyTrak+	Community bridge (OpenSkyPlus)	✓ Community	✗ Until partnered
Uneekor EYE XO / QED / MINI	Uneekor Launcher allow-list	Partner deal	★ Priority partner
Foresight GC3 / GCQuad / Bushnell	FSX partner programme (open API closed Oct 2023)	Partner deal	★ Priority partner
TrackMan 4 / iO	Closed ecosystem; terms forbid replacement software	Partner deal	★ Premium partner
Golfzon (commercial)	Closed platform	✗	Strategic deal only

CROSS-REPO FLAG

The simulator-channel plan pitches **Golfzon** bays for Virgin Active and Planet Fitness. Golfzon's commercial platform is closed, so it will not run Get Lucky Sim unless Golfzon agrees. Either make an integration or co-branded "Get Lucky mode" part of the Golfzon conversation, or spec TrackMan or Uneekor for Get Lucky-operated bays.

Build, plug in, or partner?

OPTION	WHAT IT IS	VERDICT
A. Full simulator	Compete with GSPRO and E6: courses, putting, a full round	No. 12-24 months of work, a crowded market, and golfers won't switch simulator for a par-3
B. Adjudicator app	Lightweight Unity app: one tee, one green, our own versioned physics, with the outcome decided on our server	Yes. The core product. Small scope, we own the result, and insurers can audit the maths
C. Host inside a partner	Our challenge runs inside TrackMan, GSPRO or E6	Yes, in parallel. TrackMan already runs paid, video-verified play (NEXT Golf Tour, \$100K+ purses)

Engine. Use Unity. GSPRO's whole course pipeline (OPCD, Blender and Unity) and its designer community are Unity-native. Unity scrapped its runtime fee in 2024. Unreal's 5% royalty above \$1M could apply to entry revenue.

Physics. Implement the published Penner and Nathan ball-flight models (drag, Magnus lift, spin decay), then bounce, roll and cup capture. Holmes found a ball drops only below about 1.3 m/s at the cup. The ace is decided by bounce, roll, flagstick and cup, so that code must be deterministic, versioned and published to the insurer. Use libgolf (GPL) for validation only. MIT-licensed references such as openfairway can be used freely.

■ ARCHITECTURE

Get Lucky already runs a production claims pipeline for on-course aces. It has:

- an append-only claim state machine;
- SHA-256-sealed video evidence;
- email-confirmed witnesses;
- eleven risk rules;
- an admin review checklist;
- evidence packs for the underwriter.

Get Lucky Sim reuses those concepts and that team knowledge. It does not start again.

Components

1. **Sim client (Windows, Unity).**
 - Renders the hole and listens for launch-monitor data: an Open Connect listener on a configurable port, plus partner SDK adapters.
 - Runs a local watchdog that looks for injector processes and loopback traffic.
 - Holds a TPM-backed device key.
 - Streams the bay cameras.
2. **Player web app and PWA.**
 - Handles account, wallet, KYC, history, leaderboards and claims.
 - The natural home is the existing Next.js + Supabase stack from `getluckyapp`.
 - Payments go through web checkout, so there are no app-store in-app purchase issues.

3. **Shot adjudication service.**

- Stateless and deterministic, with physics versioned by git SHA.
- Arms each attempt with a one-time nonce and a hidden per-attempt seed (micro-wind, firmness).
- Computes the outcome server-side and writes every input, seed and output to an immutable log.

4. **Ledger.**

- Double-entry in Postgres with append-only journal tables.
- Keeps entry fees, premium accruals and prize liabilities separate.

5. **Evidence store.** Direct-to-object-storage upload with write-once locking (S3 Object Lock or equivalent) and SHA-256 manifest chains. The pattern is already proven in `getluckyapp`.

6. **Claims workflow.**

- Ace → evidence freeze → KYC re-check → human review → insurer notification → payout.
- It extends the `active → claimed → verified → paid` states the on-course app already uses.

7. **Venue console.** Bay registration, camera health, staff witness sign-off, revenue share reporting and event mode.

8. **Live proctoring (Legend tier).** A WebRTC stream (LiveKit or Amazon IVS) to a remote reviewer who watches the shot live.

Suggested stack

LAYER	RECOMMENDED	WHY
Client	Unity (C#) on Windows	Simulator PCs are Windows; the Unity course pipeline already exists
Web / API	Next.js 16 + TypeScript on Vercel	The same stack as <code>getluckyapp</code> ; the team already knows it
Database / auth	Supabase Postgres (RLS), with a move to dedicated Postgres at scale	Reuse; append-only tables are already patterned
Adjudicator	TypeScript or Go service, deterministic	Portable physics, testable against Unity
Video	Object storage with write-once lock, Mux or Cloudflare Stream playback	Tamper-evident evidence
Real-time	WebSockets (Supabase Realtime, Ably or LiveKit)	Arm-shot, result, proctor
KYC / geo	Veriff or Sumsub; Radar or Xpoint, then GeoComply	Pay per check; KYC only at payout thresholds
Payments	PayFast / Peach (SA); Paysafe or Nuvei (US)	Stripe restricts skill games with prizes
Fraud	Fingerprint (device), SEON (account and payment)	Multi-account and ringer detection

 SHOT INTEGRITY & ANTI-FRAUD

Shot integrity is the whole business. One fake \$100K ace costs more than a year of Starter-tier margin, and it would lose the insurer.

Threats

- **Spoofing.** A script injects a perfect launch vector into the unauthenticated local feed.
- **Tampering.** A modified connector changes the data in flight. The Garmin R10 bridge already impersonates another program's server.
- **Replay** of a captured ace packet.
- **Golden vector.** With fixed conditions, the exact winning launch can be solved offline and injected once.
- **Physical cheats:**
 - a ball launcher or robot;
 - rolling a ball through the capture zone;
 - altitude or distance "adjust" settings;
 - hitting outside the strike zone.
- **Identity:**
 - a ringer takes the shot. This is the main fraud Samsung Fire blamed for Korea's 16× claim rate.
 - multiple accounts;
 - collusion with venue staff.

Controls, layered by prize size

INTEGRITY TIER	WHERE	DATA PATH	EVIDENCE	MAX PRIZE
Free	Anywhere	Any Open Connect source	None	No cash
Home paid (phase 2+)	Home sim	Official vendor path	Two-angle phone video from an attested app, physics checks, KYC	\$2,500–5,000
Certified venue	Partner bay, locked PC	Partner SDK or signed stream	Fixed dual cameras, staff witness, live upload	\$35,000
Legend	Certified venue	Partner cloud (e.g. TrackMan)	All of the above plus a live remote proctor	\$100,000

What the system checks on every paid shot

Arming and conditions

- **Server-armed attempt.** It gets a nonce and a 90-second window. A shot code appears on screen and must be visible on camera.
- **Hidden variation.** A per-attempt seed changes conditions slightly and is revealed only after the shot is committed. That defeats the golden vector.

The shot itself

- **Physics consistency.**
 - Carry, apex and descent must fit the launch data.
 - Smash factor must stay under the physical ceiling for the club.
 - Spin loft must match the backspin.
 - The launch must sit inside the player's own free-play distribution for that club.
- **Timing.** The camera's audio impact spike must line up with the time the shot packet arrived.
- **Device.**

- Is the launch monitor's value spacing what that device really produces?
- Are there gaps in the shot numbers, or odd heartbeat timing?
- Does any float vector exactly repeat an earlier shot?

The player

- **Identity.** KYC with a liveness check before any payout. The ID photo is face-matched to the swing video.

TrackMan precedent. TrackMan's NEXT Golf Tour already runs this way: tripod video behind the player, a split-screen of the bay and the tracer, locked settings, and taped strike zones ([NEXT rules](#)).

INSURER MAPPING

On-course hole-in-one cover requires a non-playing witness, a confirmed yardage and a signed affidavit. For \$100K+ prizes it also requires continuous video. The certified-venue tier meets all of these digitally: staff or a proctor as witness, a server-logged hole spec, video, and an e-signed affidavit.

COURSE CONTENT & LICENSING

Building the holes

- The GSPro community pipeline (OPCD: Blender, Inkscape, Unity) turns free LiDAR (USGS 3DEP in the US) and aerial imagery into playable holes.
- Full community courses cost roughly \$375–2,500 to commission.
- A **hero-quality single par-3** (photoreal, custom planting, accurate green contours) costs an estimated **\$3K–15K** and 40–120 artist hours.
- Where public LiDAR is poor, add a drone survey at roughly \$1.5K–5K per hole. The club must agree to it.

Can we use famous holes?

- ***Pebble Beach v. Tour 18* (5th Cir. 1998)** is the leading case.
 - A replica course *could* copy hole layouts, because layouts lacked trade-dress protection.
 - It *could not* use the course names, or the iconic Harbour Town lighthouse.
- Industry practice follows that line. GSPro designers ship "Georgia Golf Club" and "DPC Sodgrass".
- EA and 2K pay for official Augusta, majors and TPC licences. Fees are not public, and a real-money product makes approval harder.

Our approach:

1. Launch with "inspired-by" names and no logos or signature structures.
2. Sign branded deals with bucket-list resorts that want the exposure. In TrackMan's model the *course pays* to be mapped, and some will co-fund prizes.
3. Clear intellectual property formally before any real name appears in paid-prize marketing.

LEGAL & REGULATORY

This is desk research, not legal advice. Every paid market needs a written opinion.

The core question: skill contest or bet?

Gambling needs three things: **prize, chance and consideration**. A paid shot has a prize and consideration, so everything turns on chance. Courts use three tests:

TEST	WHAT IT ASKS	WHERE
Dominant factor	Does skill mostly decide the outcome?	Most US states, NY constitution, Illinois
Material element	Does chance play a <i>material</i> part?	NY criminal law and some others
Any chance	Is the outcome contingent on chance <i>at all</i> ?	TN, AZ, SC; Canada in effect

Two precedents help us directly:

- **Florida AGO 90-58.** A paid hole-in-one contest is not gambling when the prize is not funded from entry fees and the sponsor doesn't compete.
- **Las Vegas Hacienda v. Gibson (Nev. 1961).** A 50¢-a-shot \$5,000 hole-in-one offer was an enforceable prize contract, "not gambling".

Insurance-funded prizes fit that reasoning. **Design choices that strengthen the skill case:**

- deterministic physics, published and lab-certified (GLI or BMM);
- distance and handicap tiers;
- a closest-to-the-pin skill ladder;
- published ace statistics;
- supervised venue play.

Market-by-market

MARKET	POSITION	LAUNCH MODE
South Africa	The National Gambling Act could treat a fixed prize as a fixed-odds bet. CPA s36 bans charging entry for promotional competitions, so we can't rely on it. The existing on-course product needs a refreshed opinion before extending to sims.	Paid, phase 1 (venue bays), after an NGA/CPA opinion and provincial-board comfort letter
USA, ~38-40 dominant-factor states	Paid skill contests are widely run (Skillz, WorldWinner). Block AZ, AR, CT, DE, LA, MT, SC, SD, TN; review WA, IA, IN, ME, NV. Avoid sweepstakes "coins": CA, NY, NJ, CT, MT, IN, ME, TN, LA and OK banned them in 2025-26, with vendor liability.	Paid, phase 1b (venues, then home)
UK	The Gambling Act excludes "sport" from gaming, but a paid fixed prize could be <i>betting</i> (s9). Prize-competition rules (s14) are the target.	Phase 2 , after a counsel opinion
EU via Malta	MGA skill-games regime (Type 4: €5K application, €10K a year), but it may classify us as gaming or betting. National regimes still apply.	Phase 3 , after an MGA ruling
Canada, Australia	Chance <i>or mixed</i> games with paid entry are prohibited.	Free play and sponsor prizes (skill-testing question in Canada)
Korea, Japan	Golf betting is gambling "even if skill affects" the outcome. Japan caps promotional prizes.	Free play and sponsor prizes only
India, China, Singapore, UAE	Real-money games banned or high risk.	Exclude paid; free play only if useful

Prize promotions (free-entry sponsor prizes)

- **New York and Florida:** register and bond when total prizes exceed \$5,000.
- **Rhode Island:** register when they exceed \$500.

Estimated legal budget

ITEM	RANGE
SA opinion + regulator engagement	\$10-25K
US 50-state memo + opinion letter (needed by card networks and PSPs)	\$40-100K
US terms, privacy, responsible gaming, promotion filings	\$15-30K
PSP / card-network onboarding	\$5-15K
Phase 0-1 subtotal	\$70-170K
UK opinion	\$20-50K
Malta, first year all-in	\$200-400K
Ongoing compliance counsel	\$5-10K a month

INSURANCE & PRIZE FUNDING

Who writes this cover

Hole-in-one cover is **prize indemnity**, part of the contingency market.

- **Capacity:** Lloyd's syndicates, Beazley, Tokio Marine HCC, Everest.
- **Retail brands:** Hole In One International, US Hole In One and Odds On (all under Prize Indemnity Holdings), plus SCA Promotions, which uses contracts rather than insurance.
- **UK:** UK Hole In One is underwritten by Aviva.
- **South Africa:** Santam through Indwe.

Simulator aces are already insurable:

- **Hole-in-WON** claims 95% of simulator events worldwide (AboutGolf, Full Swing, ProTee, TruGolf).
- **PGA of Alberta** sells simulator packages.
- In **Korea**, per-game screen-golf policies sell for ₩1,000–2,000.

All of this is *event-level* or low-limit cover. **A \$100K always-on per-shot programme is new.** It needs a bespoke contingency facility with a deposit premium, per-shot declarations and a monthly aggregate cap.

What it costs

Published tournament prices imply insurers charge about **1/3,700 to 1/4,500 of the prize per shot**. For example, \$268 insures a \$10K prize for 100 golfers on a 165-yd hole.

Against a true amateur rate near 1 in 12,500, that is roughly a **3× loading**. The South African simulator model's premium of 24% of the stake implies 3–6×, the same range.

The Korean warning

Samsung Fire's screen-golf hole-in-one policy had a claim rate of **8.0%, sixteen times** the 0.5% on its on-course policy. Causes:

- controlled conditions;
- short forward tees;
- **suspected ringers.**

The product runs at a loss and is kept only for customer acquisition (Chosun). Our integrity design, minimum distances and attempt caps exist so we don't repeat this.

Odds to plan on

Real world, by distance. PGA Tour data shows odds roughly halving for every 30–40 yards added:

- 1 in 962 at 120–150 yds;
- 1 in 2,070 at 150–180 yds;
- 1 in 3,027 at 180–200 yds.

On simulators:

- Golfzon: 143,020 aces in 2022 from about 1bn par-3 shots, or **1 in 6,992**.
- Repeated attempts at one hole collapse the odds. YouTube challenges have needed only 119 to 2,627 swings.

Planning cases:

CASE	ACE RATE	WHO IT DESCRIBES
Stress	1 in 3,000	Skilled players, repeated attempts, short holes
Base	1 in 8,000	Mixed field, controls in place, 160–180 yds
Optimistic	1 in 12,500	Longer holes, like the on-course average

Recommended structure

1. **Insure Pro, Major and Legend** with a contingency carrier on an annual programme. Santam and Indwe get first refusal for South Africa. Run a Lloyd's broker process for the US.
2. **Self-insure Starter and Classic later.** Once free-play data proves the ace rate, add stop-loss reinsurance. That lifts margin to about 53–56%, but it needs a reserve of 25 maximum prizes and a regulatory check.
3. **No prize pools or jackpots funded by entries.** They look like a lottery. Fixed, insured prizes are the cleaner skill-contest structure. A weekly sponsor-funded closest-to-the-pin prize adds the jackpot feel without the risk.

 PAYMENTS, KYC & COMPLIANCE

Payments

- **Card rails.** Skill games sit under **MCC 7994**. Mastercard requires registration (about \$1K a year) and Visa's integrity-risk programme puts skill games in Tier 2. Acquirers will ask for the US legal opinion and the state block list.
- **PSPs.** Stripe lists skill games with prizes as restricted, so plan on **Paysafe or Nuvei** in the US. In South Africa use **PayFast** (already integrated in `getluckyapp`) or Peach Payments.
- **App stores.** Apple 5.3.3/5.3.4 and Google Play forbid in-app purchase for real-money contests. The PC client plus **web checkout** avoids this completely. A phone app handles accounts and video only.

Identity and location

- **KYC, tiered.**
 - Light checks at sign-up: age and database.
 - A full ID and liveness check at a deposit threshold, and always before a payout.
 - Veriff costs about \$0.80–1.89 a check and Sumsub about \$1.35–1.85. Because checks happen at payout, the cost is about **\$0.15 a paid shot**.
- **Location.** A venue bay is a registered address, so one check per session is enough there. Home play needs Radar or Xpoint, moving to GeoComply if a regulator requires it.

Player protection and tax

- **Responsible play.** 18+ (21+ where local analogues require it), deposit and spend limits, cool-off, self-exclusion, odds disclosure and signposting. This carries forward Get Lucky's existing responsible-play pages.
- **Tax (US).**
 - Skill prizes of **\$2,000 or more** (2026 threshold) go on a 1099-MISC. Collect a W-9, or apply 24% backup withholding.
 - Non-US winners have 30% withheld on a 1042-S unless a treaty applies.
 - Keep tax treatment consistent with the legal characterisation.

BUSINESS MODEL & FINANCIALS

Revenue streams

1. **Paid insured shots.** The core, at about 45% margin in the base case.
2. **Venue licence.** Venues get the base tier free and earn 20% of shot revenue. **Venue Pro** costs \$49–99 per bay per month and adds events, branding and CRM export. Golfzon venues already pay \$2–4K per bay per year for software.
3. **Sponsor-named holes.** "The [Brand] 17th", branded tee boxes, and sponsor-funded prize shots, at an indicative \$2–10K per hole per month per region.
4. **Corporate events.** A packaged "\$25K Shoot-out" for company days, at a fixed \$500–2,000 plus premium and margin.
5. **Consumer subscription.** \$79–99 a year as an *add-on* to GSPro (\$250 a year) or E6 (\$300–600 a year). It includes unlimited Collection play, stats and one free insured shot a month.
6. **Data.** Anonymised dispersion data by handicap, distance and hardware. Its biggest value is negotiating our own premiums down.

Unit economics per paid shot (base case, ace rate 1 in 8,000)

Assumptions:

- Premium at 2× expected loss.
- Venue share 20%.
- Payment fees 5%.
- KYC \$0.15, location and video \$0.02.
- Claims handling \$750 per ace.

TIER	ENTRY	PREMIUM	VENUE 20%	FEES & OPS	MARGIN	MARGIN %
Starter	\$5.00	\$0.63	\$1.00	\$0.51	\$2.86	57%
Classic	\$10.00	\$1.25	\$2.00	\$0.76	\$5.99	60%
Pro	\$25.00	\$3.75	\$5.00	\$1.51	\$14.74	59%
Major	\$50.00	\$8.75	\$10.00	\$2.76	\$28.49	57%
Legend	\$100.00	\$25.00	\$20.00	\$5.26	\$49.74	50%

Sensitivity to the ace rate:

- At the **stress case** (1 in 3,000), margins fall to 27–37% on the lower tiers and **8% on Legend**. That is why Legend is gated.
- A flat 1,000× ladder (\$5 for \$5,000) makes **0%** at 1 in 3,000.
- The blended margin is about **35% in the stress case, 45% in the base case and 55% in the optimistic case**.

Three-year scenarios (illustrative)

Assumptions:

- Average entry: \$8 (low), \$9 (base), \$10 (high).
- Venue Pro take-up: 15–35%.
- Sponsor holes: \$2K, \$4K and \$6K a month.

SCENARIO	YEAR-3 BAYS	PAID SHOTS PER BAY PER MONTH	YEAR-3 REVENUE	YEAR-3 CONTRIBUTION
Low	750	40	\$2.4M	\$1.1M
Base	2,500	80	\$16.4M	\$8.1M
High	6,000	150	\$80.0M	\$43.3M

Base-case sense checks:

- 80 paid shots a month is **fewer than 3 a day per bay**.
- The venue earns about \$144 per bay per month.
- 2,500 bays is about 5% of Golfzon's installed base alone.
- The network produces about **210 aces a year**, four a week. That is enough winners for social proof without breaking the insurer.

Break-even. Fixed opex is about \$1.5–3M a year from year 2. The base case breaks even around the end of year 2.

 TEAM, BUDGET & ROADMAP

MVP team (12 months, 9 people)

ROLE	FTE	SA-LED COST (LOADED)
Product lead	1	\$60K
Unity / physics developers	2	\$110K
Backend (ledger, adjudicator, claims)	1.5	\$83K
Integrations engineer (launch monitors)	1	\$60K
3D artist / course designer	1.5	\$60K
QA	1	\$30K
UX/UI designer	0.5	\$23K
Compliance / risk	0.5	\$35K
Team total	9	~\$470K

The same team costs about \$720K in Eastern Europe and about \$1.4M in the US.

Non-payroll MVP costs

ITEM	ESTIMATE
Legal opinions (SA + US)	\$70-170K
Hero par-3s (8-10) incl. surveys and early licences	\$50-150K
Test bays and launch monitors (TrackMan iO, Uneekor, FlightScope, Square)	\$60-100K
Security review + GLI/BMM-style physics and fairness audit	\$30-80K
Insurance programme set-up, deposit premium, E&O and cyber cover	\$50-150K
Cloud, tooling, KYC and location minimums	\$30-55K
MVP total incl. team and 15% contingency	\$0.9-1.3M

Roadmap

PHASE	WHEN	WHAT SHIPS
0: Foundations	Months 0-3	Legal opinions (SA, US), insurer term sheet, partner talks (TrackMan, Uneekor, Foresight), physics spec, first 3 holes greyboxed
1: Free play	Months 3-7	Unity client, Open Connect listener, 6 holes, accounts, leaderboards, free global launch. Actuarial data collection starts
2: Certified venues (SA)	Months 7-10	Adjudicator, ledger, cameras, venue console, claims. Paid ZAR tiers at 10-20 SA pilot bays, including Get Lucky/Golfzon gym bays if integrated
3: US venues	Months 10-12	USD ladder up to \$100K Legend, Paysafe/Nuvei, geolocation, 1099 flow. Pilot venues in dominant-factor states
4: Home paid + partners	Year 2	Attested phone-video tier for home sims, TrackMan/partner-hosted challenge, UK opinion → launch, sponsor-named holes at scale
5: Global	Year 2-3	Malta route for the EU, more languages, the Collection past 25 holes, self-insured lower tiers with stop-loss

RISK REGISTER

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Fake or spoofed ace paid out	High without controls	Severe	Server-armed attempts, hidden seeds, physics checks, cameras, witness, KYC face-match; paid play at venues first
Real ace rate higher than priced	Medium	High	Distance-scaled ladder, attempt caps, free-play actuarial data, aggregate cap in the policy
Insurer won't write per-shot \$100K cover	Medium	High	Start with Santam/Indwe in SA and lower limits; Lloyd's broker process; self-insured low tiers with stop-loss later
Market treats it as gambling	Medium	High	Market-by-market opinions, skill-strengthening design, free-play fallback everywhere
Launch-monitor makers refuse integration	Medium	Medium	Free play works on open devices now; TrackMan/Uneekor partnership is a phase-0 priority; the venue channel gives leverage
Payment rails decline	Medium	Medium	Opinion letter up front; gaming-specialist PSPs; PayFast in SA
Course IP claims	Low-medium	Medium	"Inspired-by" naming, no logos, IP clearance before marketing real names
Venue staff collusion	Low	High	Remote proctor on high tiers, rotating reviewers, anomaly flags per venue
Competitor copies or upscales it (Full Swing Skill Strike, TrackMan, Golfzon)	High	Medium	Move first, lock insurer and venue partners, own the brand and the actuarial data

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR JOHANNES

- Insurer.** Will Santam/Indwe extend the current policy to simulator aces in SA, and do they have appetite outside SA? Or do we run a Lloyd's broker process for USD cover?
- Golfzon.** Should Get Lucky Sim become part of the Golfzon conversation for the Virgin Active / Planet Fitness bays, or should Get Lucky-run bays standardise on TrackMan or Uneekor?
- Home or venue first.** Is a venue-only paid launch acceptable for the first 12 months? Home sims would stay free play plus low-limit paid shots later.
- Top prize.** Keep the **\$100K Legend** tier gated (KYC, handicap, 3 attempts a day, live witness), or cap at \$35K until the data is in?
- Brand.** Is it "Get Lucky Sim", "Get Lucky Hole-in-One Sim", or a product name under the Get Lucky umbrella?
- Team.** SA-led in-house build, or a studio partner for the Unity client with backend in-house?
- Funding.** Is the \$0.9–1.3M MVP funded from Get Lucky's balance sheet, the gym-bay debt package, or a separate raise?

SOURCES

Key sources below. Full research notes with every link are kept with the repo's working files.

Market & competitors

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- Veriff pricing: veriff.com
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